food meant for the wedding guests. Was he trying to be Robin Hood? No one could say, because he had also earned the wrath of a section of the villagers from Uduppiddy, where he was reported to have ordered the killing of an informant of the IPKF. Residents of the village said he had not even spared his own cousin who had refused to join the LTTE from a rival group.[12]

Raghuvaran was wounded in an ambush when the Sri Lankan army tried to recapture a part of Jaffna called Vadamaratchy, in May 1987. He lost an eye in the operation. Around the same time, the then Indian Prime Minister Rajiv Gandhi signed the Indo-Sri Lanka Peace Accord with the Sri Lankan President J.R. Jayawardene, paving the way for the IPKF to take temporary control of Jaffna, leading to an all-out war between the LTTE and the IPKF. Many injured cadres of the LTTE were taken to India for treatment. Sivarasan was among them. He was hopeful of getting his eye injury fixed, but that didn't happen and he was compelled to replace his lost eye with a plastic one. Raghuvaran returned to Jaffna in early 1988. It was from that time that he got into the habit of wearing sunglasses most of the time.

Raghuvaran fought the IPKF and earned the attention of the top commanders of the LTTE. Reportedly, it was he who launched the first rocket-propelled grenade on an IPKF sentry post. He was soon promoted to the post of commander and given temporary charge of Vadamaratchy.

Raghuvaran was then transferred from the military wing to the LTTE's intelligence wing, which functioned under Pottu Amman. He was promoted to captain and given a new name—Sivarasan. Captain Sivarasan of the LTTE's intelligence wing was entrusted with specific assignments, to be undertaken clandestinely in India. Among these were the expansion of the LTTE's intelligence network in India and the setting up of hideouts in Tamil Nadu. Significantly, he was tasked with carrying out the assassination of EPRLF leader K. Padmanabha.

A blueprint to assassinate Padmanabha on Indian soil was devised by Sivarasan in consultation with Pottu Amman. This entailed the deployment of a 'spy' in Madras to monitor the EPRLF's movements. Sivarasan handpicked the LTTE operative Suthenthiraraja for the mission. The